

Matt Viana

Ph.D. Student in Informatics and Intelligent Systems

Curriculum Vitae

September 2026

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Education

Aug 2025 - Present	Ph.D. in Informatics and Intelligent Systems (Advisor: Dr. Dana Calacci) University Park, PA	Pennsylvania State University
Aug 2022 - May 2025	B.S. in Data Science, Minor in Computer Science University Park, PA	Pennsylvania State University

Research Experience

Aug 2025 - Present	Working Futures Network, Penn State Graduate Research Assistant	Supervisor: Dr. Dana Calacci
	➤ Investigate user behavior and adoption patterns of Large Language Models (LLMs) in real-world settings. ➤ Conduct qualitative research and system audits to identify security vulnerabilities and privacy concerns in AI systems. ➤ Develop novel user feedback mechanisms to mitigate AI mirroring behaviors such as sycophancy and perspective mimesis. ➤ Collaborate on research projects exploring the interpretability of 'black box' AI models.	
Feb 2024 - Jan 2025	Pennsylvania State University AI Research Assistant	Adviser: Dr. Sharon Huang
	➤ Fine-tuned large language models (LLMs) using TensorFlow and PyCharm, incorporating an improved dataset and model published on Hugging Face. ➤ Conducted a literature review on multimodal emotional classification and interaction in large language models (LLMs). ➤ Researched NLP and Computer Vision techniques, focusing on the development of models to analyze a wide emotional spectrum. ➤ Ran experiments integrating audio, visual, and textual inputs into language models, utilizing clustering techniques and data augmentation.	

Publications

2026	Interaction Context Often Increases Sycophancy in LLMs → S Jain, C Park, M M Viana, A Wilson, D Calacci [CHI] ACM CHI 2026 (Accepted, Honorable Mention Award for Outstanding Contribution)
2026	What Changes Inside an LLM When Memory Replaces Your History M Viana, D Calacci [ICLR] International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2027), Under Review
2026	"If You're Not Doing It, Somebody Else Is": Active Negotiation and the Invisible Labor of Sustained LLM Use M Viana, P Erickson, S Wilson, D Calacci [CHI] ACM CHI 2027, Under Review

Awards & Funding

2026	Honorable Mention Award Recipient <i>ACM CHI Conference</i>
2025-2026	Jordan Rednor Scholarship Recipient <i>College of Information Sciences and Technology</i>
2025	ICDS Rising Researcher Grant Recipient <i>Institute for Computational and Data Sciences, Pennsylvania State University</i>

Invited Talks

Feb 2026	Guest Research Talk University Park, PA	Plain Text Lab (Dr. Jonathan Dodge), Pennsylvania State University
Dec 2025	Rising Researcher Talk University Park, PA	Institute for Computational and Data Sciences, Pennsylvania State University

Conference Presentations

Jun 2026	Interaction Context Often Increases Sycophancy in LLMs (Short Talk) AI, Metascience, and Methodology, Consortium on Moral Decision-Making \& Center for Social Data Analytics, Pennsylvania State University University Park, PA	AI and Social Research: Empathic
Jun 2026	Active Negotiation: How Users Interact With and Adopt Large Language Models (Poster) Research: Empathic AI, Metascience, and Methodology, Consortium on Moral Decision-Making \& Center for Social Data Analytics, Pennsylvania State University University Park, PA	AI and Social

Mentoring

June 2025 - Present	Patrick Erickson Undergraduate B.S. in Data Science. Research project focused on the adoption and integration of LLMs.	Pennsylvania State University
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Skills

- **Research Methods:** Qualitative Analysis, AI Auditing, User Studies, Human-Computer Interaction (HCI)
- **Technical:** Machine Learning, Artificial Intelligence, Natural Language Processing
- **Programming:** Python, R, SQL

Memberships

2025 - Present	Association for Computing Machinery (ACM)
2025 - Present	Center for Socially Responsible Artificial Intelligence (CSRAI)